

"While delivery is still a part of the job, much greater emphasis is being placed on attaining a far broader set of business objectives," Rowsell-Jones added.

The survey shows that a majority of CIO respondents believe that technology trends such as cyber security and artificial intelligence are set to significantly change their jobs in the near future. Moreover, around 35 per cent of the total respondents said that they have already invested and deployed some aspect of digital security, while 36 per cent are planning to implement some form of digital security.

Despite the positivity towards the change in their role, Rowsell-Jones believes that organisational culture could be a roadblock to success.

"CIOs need to identify the cultural behaviours that currently exist and what the future vision is. In doing so, they must recognise existing cultural strengths and position cultural change as 'the next chapter', rather than a massive overhaul, to respect employees' contributions and invite them to come along on the journey," said Rowsell-Jones.

At least 84 per cent of top CIOs surveyed have responsibility for areas of the business outside traditional IT. The ideal balance, as per the responses, is 56 per cent related to business outcomes, such as revenue growth, business margins and influencing business strategy, and 44 per cent related to IT delivery.

Respondents to the survey were categorised as top, typical and trailing performers in digitalisation. Some CIOs favour a separate digital team to boost their enterprise's digital business while others consider digitalisation part of their job.

Microsoft joins Open Source Initiative as 'Premium' sponsor

Microsoft has joined the Open Source Initiative (OSI) as a 'Premium' sponsor.



The new development has happened months after the Redmond company entered the membership agreement with the Linux Foundation and is another significant effort to ensure a feeling of good faith with open source contributors.

"This is a significant milestone for the OSI and the open source software movement

more broadly," said Patrick Masson, general manager and board director, OSI.

The relationship between OSI and Microsoft is not a new one. In fact, the two organisations have been in touch for more than a decade, dating back to 2005. The Windows maker even opted for an open source licence when releasing .NET in 2014, a move that explicitly demonstrated the firm's interest in the community-driven space.

"As Microsoft engages with open source communities more broadly and deeply, we are excited to support the Open Source Initiative's efforts," said Jeff McAffer, director of Microsoft's open source programs office.

Since the release of the open source .NET Core back in November 2014, Microsoft has become part of a list of open source communities and organisations such as Open Source Eclipse Foundation, Cloud Native Computing Foundation and Cloud Foundry Foundation. In November 2016, the company joined the Linux Foundation to prove its support for Linux, something that CEO Satya Nadella has often mentioned at enterprise-focused events in the past.

Microsoft has joined Facebook, Google, GitHub and IBM by sponsoring the OSI. The corporate sponsorship gives the non-profit organisation a way to

Microsoft expands its portfolio of machine learning tools

Microsoft has launched a new range of machine learning tools at its annual Ignite conference. With the new launch, the Windows maker wants to enable developers to utilise easy artificial intelligence (AI) based tools to build new advancements.

The new tools are the Azure Machine Learning Workbench, Azure Machine Learning Experimentation Service and the Azure Machine Learning Model Management Service. These are designed to help developers working on new AI models, as well as those who simply want to use pre-existing models.

The Azure Machine Learning Experimentation Service is designed to help developers deploy ML experiments. Microsoft has added support for open source frameworks like Caffe2, PyTorch, TensorFlow, CNTK and Cahiner. The experimentation service is designed to scale from local machines to hundreds of GPUs in the cloud.

Machine Learning Workbench, on the other hand, is a desktop client for Windows and Mac. The tool can act as a control panel for your development life cycle. Lastly, the Azure Machine Learning Model Management Service uses Docker containers. Developers can manage and deploy their models to any Docker container using the service. The company has also included its own Kubernetes-based Azure Container Service within the learning workbench to enhance the coverage of its native development.

All the new machine learning developments are a part of Microsoft's AI platform, which the company claims serves over 650,000 sessions per week.